

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 389

By Williams

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Velma Christine Tidwell Bates on the celebration of her 100th birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, Velma Christine Tidwell Bates will celebrate her 100th birthday on March 22, 2025, a milestone that will be commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, the daughter of Gillie and Ella Tidwell, Velma Bates was born in the Knob Creek area of Lawrence County, where she grew up as one of twelve siblings; and

WHEREAS, Velma Bates has lived a blessed life, having experienced firsthand the most eventful and productive years in American history; and

WHEREAS, joined in holy matrimony on December 6, 1941, she enjoyed fifty-four years of marriage with her husband, James Gerald Bates, also a native of Lawrence County, before his passing in 1996; and

WHEREAS, during their years together, the Bates lived in Southern California during World War II and worked at Firestone Tire and Rubber, making tires and rubberized gas tanks for aircraft for the war effort; and

WHEREAS, the Bateses lived in California into the late 1950s, at which time they and their three children, Carol, Barbara, and Doug, returned to Lawrence County; and

WHEREAS, a gracious and generous woman, Velma Bates has held many different jobs during her lifetime, but being a homemaker and nurturer, expressing her love for all through her preparation of large, delicious meals, has been her greatest joy; and

WHEREAS, a beloved family matriarch, Ms. Bates enjoys the love and support of her three children, eight grandchildren, sixteen great-grandchildren, and four great-great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and congratulate Velma Christine Tidwell Bates on the celebration of her 100th birthday and extend to her our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.